

TravAID — Check Coolant & Overheating

Duration: 10 min • Difficulty: Easy

Safety: NEVER open the radiator cap on a hot engine — pressurised steam will cause serious burns. Wait 30+ minutes after stopping.

Step 1. Pull over safely

If the temp gauge climbs into the red, turn off A/C and turn the heater on full to draw heat away from the engine. Pull over as soon as it's safe.

Step 2. Switch off and wait

Open the bonnet to release heat. Wait at least 30 minutes for the engine to cool.

Step 3. Inspect the reservoir

Locate the translucent coolant reservoir (usually marked with MIN/MAX). Check the level against the cold mark.

Step 4. Top up if low

Use 50/50 pre-mixed coolant if available, or clean water in an emergency. Refit the cap firmly.

Step 5. Look for leaks

Check under the car for puddles. Look at hoses for splits or wet spots. A leak means you need a mechanic — don't keep driving.

Step 6. Start carefully

Restart and watch the gauge. If it climbs again, stop and call for towing — running an overheated engine causes permanent damage.